

Priority Negotiating Party Selection Results

1. Project Name: Former Mitsue Elementary School Utilization Project

2. Selection Date: January 27, 2026 (Reiwa 8)

3. Selection Method: Open-call Proposal (Public Solicitation Proposal System)

4. Selection Results

(1) Priority Negotiating Party

103-17 Kawai, Iga City, Mie Prefecture

Ao Bara Co., Ltd. (青薔薇株式会社)

Representative Director: Koji Morita (森田浩次)

(2) Runner-up: None

5. Score Breakdown

See attached sheet below.

Note: Only the priority negotiating party and runner-up applicant names are publicly disclosed.

Note: Evaluation criteria are as stipulated in the Former Mitsue Elementary School Utilization Project Business Operator Recruitment Guidelines.

Research Notes — Company & Intended Use

About Ao Bara Co., Ltd. (青薔薇株式会社)

- **Corporate number:** 3190001028580
- **Address:** 103-17 Kawai, Iga City, Mie Prefecture (same as declared in the proposal)
- **Founded:** August 2021
- **Status:** Private company (unlisted)
- **Representative Director:** Koji Morita (森田浩次)
- **Business activities:** Not publicly specified in available business registries (gBizINFO, SalesNow). No patents, certifications or subsidies on record. The company appears to have been established specifically around the time the school closed (September 2021) and the village began its reuse process.

Specific business plans have not yet been publicly disclosed. Mitsue Village's official website states that full details will be announced *after negotiations with the priority negotiating party are concluded.*

Why Ao Bara Won

Looking at the score breakdown, Ao Bara significantly outperformed the other two applicants in **Utilization Plan** (413 vs 304 and 272 out of 630) — the highest-weighted category. This suggests their proposal contained a specific, compelling, and well-detailed plan for the facility. They also led in the General Business Proposal and Regional Revitalization categories, though they did not offer the highest rent (81 vs Applicant A's 90).

About the School Building

The former Mitsue Elementary School is an architecturally notable building:

- Designed by architect **Aoki Jun**, the main building features a striking **dome structure** with a spiral slab framework (interior diameter 36m, exterior max 57m).
- The school was consolidated from three smaller village schools on April 1, 1996, and operated until **September 2021**, when it merged with the middle school due to extreme rural depopulation (only 19 students in six grades at closure).
- The campus temporarily housed the village library after closure.
- The building is listed in Japan's Agency for Cultural Affairs database as a modern cultural heritage structure.

Village's Stated Goals for Reuse

The village conducted a **sounding-type market survey (Aug 2024 – Feb 2025)** to gauge private sector interest before opening the formal proposal process. The recruitment guidelines (released June 2025, revised August 2025) evaluated proposals on four criteria: general business viability, utilization plan, contribution to regional revitalization, and rental price. The village explicitly sought proposals that leverage the building's unique architecture and the area's natural mountain environment.

Common reuse categories explored nationally for similar closed rural schools include accommodation/lodging, outdoor activity bases, cultural facilities, and co-working/satellite office spaces — but Ao Bara's specific concept has not been confirmed publicly.

Sources

- [旧御杖小学校利活用事業／御杖村](#)
- [御杖村立御杖小学校 — Wikipedia](#)
- [青薔薇株式会社 — gBizINFO](#)
- [青薔薇株式会社 — NIKKEI COMPASS](#)
- [御杖小学校 建築 — AOKI.JUN WORKS](#)

Attachment — Score Breakdown Table

Project Name: Former Mitsue Elementary School Utilization Project

App. No.	Applicant	Total Score (max: 1,350 pts)	1. General Business Proposal (max: 450 pts)	2. Utilization Plan Proposal (max: 630 pts)	3. Regional Revitalization Contribution Proposal (max: 180 pts)	4. Rent / Price Proposal (max: 90 pts)
3	Ao Bara Co., Ltd. <i>(Priority Negotiating Party)</i>	894	297	413	103	81
1	Applicant A	647	181	304	72	90
2	Applicant B	622	187	272	82	81